WESTON (*arresting her as she is going out of the door*): Oh Frances! What was in the parcel, do you think?

LADY WESTON: That was your new velvet cloak, dear. I did try to tell you, you know.

(*Exit*).

(***The curtain comes down on LORD WESTON ruefully taking the first dripping cloak from the water***).

About The Author

Gordon Daviot (1896 – 1952) is the pen name of Miss.Elizabeth McKintosh, a Scottish born novelist and playwright. She served educational institutions in England and Scotland as a physical education instructor and soon took to writing novels under another pseudonym Josephine Tey.



Glossary

twiddling my thumbs	-	being idle
Charles II	-	King of England from 1660 to 1685
foot pad	-	highway-man (robber) who goes about on foot (highwaymen on horseback were more common in those days)
game pie	-	meat (of animals or birds hunted and killed) covered with pastry and baked
lawdamussy	-	an exclamation (lord have mercy)
minutiae	-	minute details (often trivial)
gingerly	-	carefully
infernal	-	a concealed or disguised explosive device intended to destroy life or property
ilex tree	-	evergreen oak tree also called holm oak
foil	-	to frustrate or thwart the efforts of the assassin (i.e. to kill himself by handling that rusty pistol is a poor way of outwitting the assassin)
excursions and alarms	-	(alarms and excursions) noise and bustle (as those made on the stage to represent battles etc.)

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